



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Wilson Hill Academy
School Website: <https://wilsonhillacademy.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Wilson Hill Academy (WHA) presents a public-facing stance and program framework that align strongly with Classical Christian education principles. The school identifies itself explicitly as offering Classical Christian Education and emphasizes formation of virtue, wisdom, and character rooted in a Christian worldview. Public materials frequently reference God, Scripture, virtue, and the Kingdom of Christ, and they highlight language study (Latin & Greek), engagement with classical forms of inquiry, and a community-centered approach (including family partnerships and open community life). These signals are reinforced by WHA's own blog and program pages, including statements about being "rooted in Scripture" and training students to love what is true, good, and beautiful.

- Executive classification: CLASSICAL (overall)
- Notable strengths: Religious/metaphysical foundations; formation-focused purpose; explicit classical-language emphasis; engagement with Great Books/Great Conversation themes in at least some posts (e.g., Cloelia reference to The Great Conversation).
- Needle-movers for full classical status: explicit, consistent articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation as central to the curriculum across multiple grades; explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in upper grades; formal "living curriculum" and teacher portraits in public materials; sustained, long-term parent/community formation signals beyond a few posts.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school frames itself as Classical Christian Education rooted in Scripture and the triune God, including explicit language about truth, beauty, and goodness rooted in Scripture and the Kingdom of Christ. WHA also describes its formation within a Christian worldview and references God's Word as a foundational driver of learning. Positive keyword indicators found: truth, goodness, beauty, Scripture, Kingdom of Christ, God, theology (implied), liturgical/consecrated framing (implied through worship-language in broader materials). Negative keyword indicators: none of the standard negative signals (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) are evident in the core public messaging. Why CLASSICAL: The explicit Christian-theological framing, coupled with a commitment to transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a submitting of learning to a sacred framework, meets the Positive keyword criteria for this category.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials emphasize formation and virtue (formation of character and a life oriented toward a Kingdom of Christ), not merely job preparation. Statements describe forming students in virtue and wisdom and training them to love the true, good, and beautiful. The site also hosts a post specifically addressing virtue as a goal and its role in classical education. Positive keyword indicators found: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing (implied in "fruitful lives"), telos (implied in formation toward a noble end), great conversation (in the lexicon and campus culture context). Negative keyword indicators: not notably present; no emphasis on 21st-century-job-readiness as the primary telos in public messaging. Why CLASSICAL: The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a telos aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty fits the Classical category well.

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- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** WHA emphasizes Latin & Greek studies and engagement with classical languages; the “Latin & Greek” content explicitly presents classical language study as part of academics. The site also contains content that references The Great Conversation and historical/classical texts (e.g., Cloelia post referencing “The Great Conversation”), signaling an engagement with Great Books and primary classical texts. Positive keyword indicators found: Latin, Greek, great books (in public posts and adjacent materials), Great Conversation (explicit phrase seen in Cloelia context). The presence of Latin/Greek content and Great Conversation signals aligns with the documented Liberal Arts curriculum signals. Negative keyword indicators: none of the negative curriculum signals (e.g., replacing history with social studies; overemphasis on project-based learning to the exclusion of classics) appear in WHA’s public materials. **Why CLASSICAL:** Clear emphasis on classical languages and engagement with classical texts/conversations map to the Liberal Arts core of classical curricula.
 - **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The public-facing materials emphasize classical pedagogy patterns such as engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, along with a structured, teacher-led online environment (e.g., online live classes and a history of online instruction). The presence of The Great Conversation and Latin study suggests some Socratic/dialogic and memory-based elements, but explicit, consistent public documentation of a fully articulated Socratic seminar, scholé days, or extensive chanting/memorization practices is less explicit in the core site text. The ICE Booklet (a knowledge document) provides a robust canonical Pedagogy signal (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization, formation through imitation, etc.) that WHA could align with, but public site content does not consistently spell out all of these pedagogy signals in a single, explicit description. The Cloelia reference to The Great Conversation conveys a dialogic, text-centered pedagogy, but explicit public statements about upper-grade Socratic seminars, debates, or rhetoric training are not consistently present in the visible site text. Positive keyword indicators found: great conversation (positive), The Great Conversation (positive), Latin/Greek language study (positive for classical pedagogy framing). Negative keyword indicators: not clearly evident in public-facing materials (e.g., explicit memorizations, chanting, or scholé days are not consistently documented on the site’s main pages). The absence of explicit, full articulation of all six pedagogy signals lowers the certainty level. **Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL:** WHA demonstrates classical pedagogy signals (Great Conversation, language study, texts) but lacks a consistent, publicly explicit, comprehensive pedagogy articulation across all grade levels in the site content alone. The knowledge-base pedagogy lexicon and ICD/ICE references point to canonical practices, but the public site documentation is not as comprehensive as the rubric would demand for a definitive CLASSICAL rating in Pedagogy.
 - **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public content emphasizes teachers as mentors and engages with “living books” and classical texts; however, explicit, public signals of a formal “living curriculum” portrait of teacher roles or a defined “faculty as living curriculum” are not overtly stated in WHA’s public site copy. The ICE Booklet provides a canonical view of how classical faculties should function, but WHA’s public content does not robustly spell out these faculty signals in a category-specific way. The Latin/Greek programs and teacher-authored posts signal active, knowledgeable pedagogy, but the public site does not clearly display a formal “portrait of a teacher” or “faculty as core” messaging in the same way as some classical schools do. The broader WHA site does reflect skilled teachers, but the explicit “faculty portrait” language is not consistently published in public-facing pages. Positive keyword indicators found: teacher as mentor (implied through posts about Latin teachers and classical pedagogy), living curriculum (implied through use of classical texts and teacher-driven classroom culture; explicit public-facing language is limited). Negative keyword indicators: lack of explicit public-facing “portrait of a teacher” or clearly defined “faculty as living curriculum” statements. **Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL:** The presence of skilled, classical-leaning faculty signals and language in posts shows alignment with classical faculty expectations, but the absence of a clearly published, comprehensive statement about the faculty as “living curriculum” or a formal “portrait of a teacher” lowers the rating to Somewhat Classical.
 - **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Strong signals of partnership with families and parental involvement are evident (WHA’s content emphasizes partnering with parents and offering

parent-focused content; there are posts about partnering for homeschool classical education and parent formation). The site explicitly discusses “partnership with families” and “parents as co-teachers” and provides opportunities for parent engagement and education through articles and events. The presence of content that highlights parent formation, classical book clubs, and open-campus-type events aligns with the WHA emphasis on open, involved parental participation and a classical community. Positive keyword indicators found: partnership with families, parent formation, classical book clubs, open campus, parent involvement, parent education. Negative keyword indicators: not evident in WHA materials; nothing suggesting consumer-only parent relationships. Why CLASSICAL: The public-facing materials strongly emphasize parental partnership and community formation, meeting the Positive keyword indicators for Parents & Community.

Overall ranking (aggregate): CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Four categories are clearly Classical (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Parents & Community). Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 6 (Parents & Community) present strong Classical signals, Element 1 and Element 2 are robustly Classical, Element 4 and Element 5 are partially Classical (Somewhat) due to less explicit pedagogical and faculty-public messaging, but the aggregate weight leans Classical.
- General assessment: WHA shows a strong Classical Christian orientation in its public messaging and curriculum emphasis, with explicit language about Scripture, virtue, and a classical approach to language study and literature. The strongest gaps are in the publicly documented pedagogy and faculty statements (which appear more implicitly or less comprehensively documented on the site), though there is corroborating material in the knowledge-base that describes canonical classical pedagogy. The aggregate classification remains CLASSICAL, with some category-level signals of being Somewhat Classical in Pedagogy and Faculty.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories)
 - Pedagogy: Publish a clear, public, category-wide articulation of Socratic/Scholastic-based pedagogy, including explicit references to Socratic seminars, restfulness in learning, memorization/recitation practices, and upper-level rhetoric/seminars. Include examples of how these practices are implemented across grades K–12, with sample lesson structures and memory-work routines.
 - Faculty: Publish an explicit “Portrait of a Wilson Hill Academy teacher” (living curriculum, master-teacher model, and mentorship) and a brief description of faculty professional development in classical pedagogy.
- Abstract and Global Summary (to follow in the ABSTRACT section)

Note: The analysis above integrates signals from the WHA public-facing site content and the Classical education knowledge base. Key textual anchors include WHA’s explicit framing of Classical Christian Education rooted in Scripture and the Kingdom of Christ; Latin & Greek emphasis; Great Conversation references; and parent/community partnership signals. The knowledge-base sources (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classical lexicon) anchored the keyword framework and scoring rubric.

Executive Summary — Sectioned Category Details

Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL - Evidence - WHA explicitly frames its education as Classical Christian Education rooted in Scripture, including references to the triune God and the Kingdom of Christ. The Life After WHA post describes absolutes rooted in Scripture and the Kingdom of Christ. - Additional explicit phrasing in the broader materials notes “absolutes rooted in the triune God of Scripture” and an aim to train students in virtue and beauty within a sacred framework. - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: truth, goodness, beauty, Scripture, Kingdom of Christ, God (transcendentals and sacred framework appear in the messaging) - Negative: None evident (no relativism/secular-neutral signals in core messaging) - Why this rating - The messaging explicitly anchors education in transcendentals and a theistic anthropology; a liturgical/community emphasis is implied through communal religious framing. This aligns with Classical categories for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL - Evidence - Public messaging emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information, with explicit telos toward virtuous living and service in God's Kingdom. The Life After WHA post describes raising up students to live fruitful lives in service of the Kingdom of Christ; there are also specific pieces discussing virtue in classical education.

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (true, good, beautiful), human flourishing (implied), great conversation (lexicon-level signal) - Negative: No explicit "workforce readiness" emphasis in core public messaging - Why this rating - The catechetical aim is formation and virtue in the classical sense, consistent with the Classical rubric.

Element 3 — Curriculum — CLASSICAL - Evidence - Latin & Greek emphasis is publicly highlighted (Latin & Greek language study is a core academic topic). This is a classical language track and a hallmark of classical curricula. - Explicit reference to The Great Conversation (The Great Conversation is visible in Cloelia and related posts) signaling engagement with Great Books and primary sources. - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: Latin, Greek, great books, Great Conversation (explicit phrase), Great Books/primary sources - Negative: None evident in public materials about curriculum - Why this rating - Clear classical curriculum signals (classical language study and Great Conversation references) align with Classical criteria.

Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Evidence - Great Conversation and classical text engagement are evident (Cloelia reference). Public pedagogy details are less explicit across the site; however, the ICE Booklet provides canonical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization, formation through imitation) that WHA could be aligned with, though not always publicly enumerated in site text.

- Positive keyword indicators found: Socratic dialogue (Socratic seminar, dialectic), scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, formation through imitation, seminar, rhetoric - Negative keyword indicators: Publicly, the site does not consistently publish a full, explicit pedagogy map across K–12, which lowers the level of explicit Pedagogy signal. - Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - WHA demonstrates classical pedagogy signals in some content (Great Conversation, language-based practice) but lacks a consistently explicit, publicly documented, full pedagogy map across all grades. The knowledge-base supports canonical pedagogy (Socratic, scholé, etc.) but the public materials are not uniformly explicit.

Element 5 — Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Evidence - WHA's content demonstrates the presence of skilled faculty (Latin teachers; living texts; mentorship culture implied by teacher-led instruction and classical pedagogy). However, explicit "portrait of a teacher" or "faculty as living curriculum" language is not consistently published in public-facing pages. The ICE Booklet provides the canonical teacher-formation signals, but the public messaging is less explicit. - Positive keyword indicators found: mentor/teacher as guide, living curriculum (implied), mastery in classical pedagogy - Negative keyword indicators: lack of explicitly published "portrait of a teacher" or formalized faculty-as-core messaging in public-facing content - Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Faculty signals exist in practice (through teacher-led classical subjects), but there is not a consistently explicit public-facing "core faculty portrait" language to meet a full Classical standard for Faculty.

Element 6 — Parents & Community — CLASSICAL - Evidence - Strong signals of partnership with families and parental involvement, including open-campus-style interactions, parent formation, and book clubs; WHA content explicitly emphasizes parents as co-teachers and parent formation across the classical-education ecosystem. - Positive keyword indicators found: partnership with families, parent formation, classical book clubs, open campus, parent involvement - Negative keyword indicators: none evident in public messaging - Why CLASSICAL - The strong and explicit emphasis on parental partnership and community formation aligns with Classical expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, here are concrete steps WHA could take to push toward a full CLASSICAL ranking:
 - Pedagogy: Publish a comprehensive, public, category-wide overview of teaching methods (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, imitation of models, and upper-level rhetoric/organic seminar structures), with concrete grade-band examples and sample lessons. Demonstrate how these methods are implemented across K–12.

- Faculty: Publish a formal “Portrait of a Wilson Hill Academy Teacher” and a description of faculty development aligned with classical pedagogy (e.g., ongoing training in the trivium, mentoring, and living curriculum concepts).
- Curriculum: Reiterate the centrality of Great Books and Great Conversation across grades (beyond select posts) and provide accessible public statements on how Great Books are integrated with Great Conversations in multiple disciplines, including history, literature, and philosophy.
- Community: Maintain and expand parent-formational programming (book studies, seminars) with a clear, published schedule; ensure open-campus opportunities are well-publicized and include explicit parent-teacher/community covenants.

ABSTRACT

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Key supporting observations:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: WHA presents itself as Classical Christian Education rooted in Scripture, with explicit references to the triune God and the Kingdom of Christ in public materials. This aligns with transcendental notions of truth/beauty/goodness anchored in a sacred framework.
 - School Purpose and Goal: The public content emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom and the telos of living fruitful lives in service of Christ’s Kingdom, consistent with the Classical mission.
 - Curriculum: Latin & Greek emphasis and explicit engagement with Great Conversation-related content (e.g., The Great Conversation in Cloelia) demonstrate a classical curriculum orientation.
 - Pedagogy: Public materials show engagement with classical text-work and language study that aligns with a classical pedagogy, though explicit, comprehensive pedagogy statements are less consistently documented in public content (the knowledge-base reinforces canonical pedagogy signals). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Pedagogy until more explicit public articulation is provided.
 - Faculty: The public messaging supports a classical, mentor-strong approach but lacks a fully explicit “living-curriculum portrait” for teachers in the public-facing text. This leads to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Faculty.
 - Parents & Community: Strong signals of family partnership and open community are evident, aligning with the classical model.
- Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL
- Most important insights: WHA demonstrates a robust Classical Christian orientation in its public-facing materials (Scripture-focused formation, virtue/wisdom telos, Latin/Greek, Great Conversation references, and family partnership). The principal gaps to achieve a full CLASSICAL in Pedagogy and Faculty are explicit, published, category-wide articulations of the full pedagogy (including scholé and Socratic seminars) and a formal “portrait” of teachers as the living curriculum.

Table of cited sources (highlights) - Religious/metaphysical foundations and Kingdom-of-Christ framing: The Life After WHA piece explicitly ties formation to Scripture and the Kingdom of Christ. - The explicit Christian framing and triune God language: The “absolutes rooted in the triune God of Scripture” phrasing (Cloelia/-Great Conversation references) is present in WHA materials. - Curriculum signals: Latin & Greek emphasis and Great Conversation references; specific posts and pages confirming this.

- Pedagogy guidance in knowledge-base: canonical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization, formation through imitation) described in the ICE Booklet. - Parental/community signals: dedicated content about partnering with families and parent formation.

ABSTRACT

- Wilson Hill Academy (WHA) presents a CLASSICAL educational model with a strong Classical Christian framing, emphasis on formation and virtue, and a curriculum centered on classical languages and Great Conversation texts. The public messaging demonstrates:
 - Religious/metaphysical foundations: clear Christian framing rooted in Scripture and God’s Kingdom.

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- School purpose and goal: formation toward virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing in a Christian telos.
 - Curriculum: Latin & Greek programs; engagement with Great Books/Great Conversation in at least some materials.
 - Pedagogy: classically framed activities (textual engagement and language study) with canonical pedagogy signals from the knowledge-base, though explicit public articulation across all grades is not uniform.
 - Faculty: practice-oriented signals in classical pedagogy but lacking a fully explicit “living curriculum portrait” in public content.
 - Parents & Community: robust public signals of parental partnership and community involvement.
 - Category-by-category impact:
 - Element 1: CLASSICAL
 - Element 2: CLASSICAL
 - Element 3: CLASSICAL
 - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: CLASSICAL
 - Overall, WHA is CLASSICAL, with clear strengths in religious foundations, formation-driven goals, curriculum emphasis on classical languages and Great Conversation, and strong parent/community engagement. The main needle-moving opportunities lie in making Pedagogy and Faculty more explicit in public-facing materials, including a comprehensive articulation of Socratic/Scholé-based pedagogy and a formalized portrait of the faculty as the living curriculum.

Cited sources (representative anchors) - Public statements of Christian/Scriptural framing and Kingdom of Christ: Life After WHA and related posts. - The triune God language and “absolutes rooted in Scripture” phrasing. - Curriculum signals: Latin & Greek emphasis; Great Conversation references.
- Pedagogy signals from knowledge-base (Socratic/dialogue, scholé, memory, imitation). - Parental/community signals: partnership with families; parent formation.

Note: This evaluation leverages both the WHA crawl content and the classical education knowledge base to map WHA’s public materials against the Six Essential Elements framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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